

Final report Design Process and Prototyping

Introduction

This document presents the main information, findings and results obtained during the process of developing the design and prototyping process for this first project delivery.

Prototyping and modeling helped us understand the company's internal processes and define our image and way of dealing with the client. Finally, to test these points, an example case was carried out, which gave us many interesting insights into our way of working.

Prototyping

The process of prototyping the website was very important, as it will be our only means of attracting customers, apart from word of mouth. After more than a year idealizing the startup, it was very special to “bring it to life” in a way, and the construction of the mockup to detail the wireframe did this very well.

After the market analysis, we decided that it was ideal for the site to have a one-page website format, as it doesn't need to contain a lot of information. The only page we decided to keep separate was the blog.

When analyzing our competitors, we noticed that most of them have, if not a blog, an academic area, in which they offer several courses, podcasts and lives in the area. As we don't yet have the knowledge to teach other people, but we can't help but prove our knowledge, we're going to create a blog page.

LOGO

[what is?](#)

[why us](#)

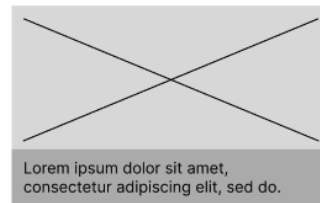
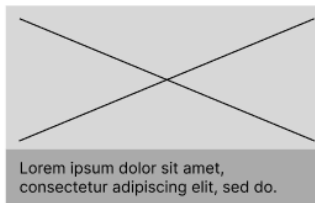
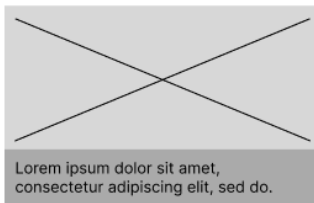
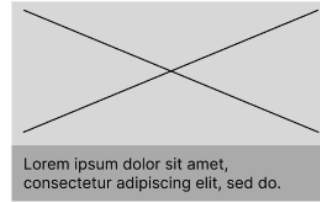
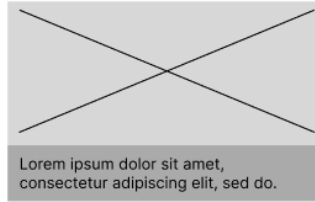
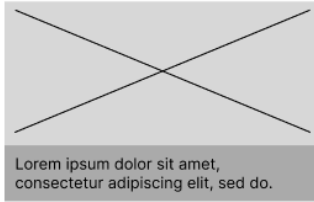
[services](#)

[about us](#)

[contact](#)

[blog](#)

(startup name) blog



As it is no longer a well-known service, we understood that when opening the site the client already needed to feel impacted, which is why we left only the horizontal navigation menu and an image (representative of the digital investigation area) with our slogan in the middle. The rest of the site covers the most relevant points: what digital investigation is, our differentials, our services, about us and contact details. For reasons of privacy of the company's image, since the site has not yet been launched, only the wireframe images can be released.

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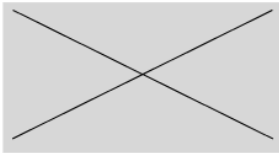
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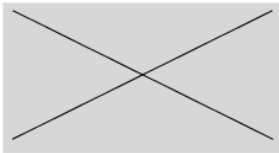
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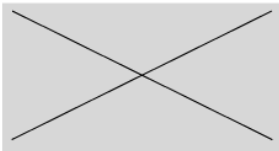
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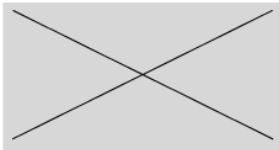
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About us

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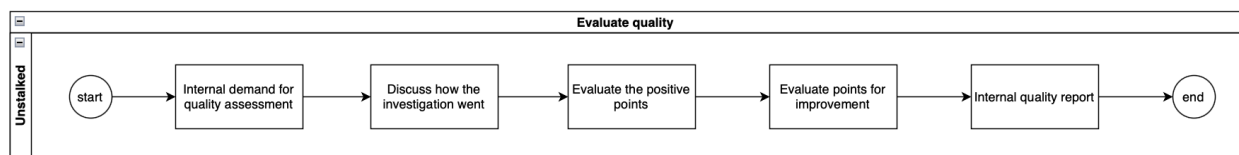
Modeling

In this part of the project I defined, using IDEF0 modeling, the general process that my partner and I must follow, from what to do when a request comes in, to the stages after the investigation is finished and the final report is delivered. Among various inputs, outputs, rules and tools, I was able to discover important parts to consider that I hadn't taken into account.

Before designing everything, I imagined the company receiving the demand, making a negotiation and already starting the investigation, but I realized the need to take a moment after signing the contract to assess which tools we will use and define an execution plan. This ensures that we are more objective during the investigation, which can save time.

I also thought that once the final report had been delivered to the client, the process as a whole would come to an end, but I've added two more super necessary topics. The first is the quality assessment, in which my partner and I will get together to discuss the investigation, pointing out the positive and negative points and making an action plan for the improvements identified. The second is the portfolio. From the outset I dismissed this possibility for privacy reasons, but I understand that it is necessary to help us convince potential clients to close the contract. Even so, the sharing of information (always excluding sensitive data) can only take place if permitted in writing and signed by the selected clients. For internal privacy reasons, no images of the IDEF0 model will be shown.

In order to improve each sub-process identified in the idef0 modeling, a BPMN diagram was created for each one. This step was essential, as it made me realize that I had forgotten some details during the previous modeling, and so I was able to make the process even more complete. Below is an example of the BPMN diagram for the quality assessment sub-process:



Example case

Finally, in order to put into practice everything that had been defined in the modeling process, an example case was made. This was a very important stage, as it helped us to understand the internal processes in practice and what we could improve immediately.

The first interesting observation is that the case actually came about through word of mouth, in which my partner commented to a friend about the idea of the startup and he replied with “wow, I think I need your help, I need some information to help me in a court case, do you think you can get it for me?”. The reason this comment is so valuable is that even before the official launch of the website and service, we are already getting clients.

Following what was planned in the modeling, we had the process of negotiating and closing the contract. It was important to realize that we didn't do any of this, and that if the client hadn't been a friend of my father's, it could have harmed us, as well as being a very informal process. With regard to the negotiation, the reason we didn't reach a final figure was because we agreed with the client that he would only pay us if he managed to use the information collected in his favor in the court case, and today, given that some time has passed, I believe this wasn't possible and that's why we won't receive anything for the work done. In addition, the part about signing the contract was overlooked, as the deadline for the final report was very short, so there was no time to draw up a contract from scratch for signing.

We learned from this event that we need to have a model contract ready to replicate for all our clients, and that keeping the negotiation the way it was can be a good strategy at the beginning to attract clients and guarantee a good image, since if we can't help the client, at least he didn't pay for it. On the other hand, this is something we can only do with close and trusted friends, as we have no guarantee that strangers will be honest at the end of the investigation and say whether the result was really valid or not.

The last relevant point about the example case was the delivery of the final report. Unfortunately, my partner and I didn't see eye to eye on this, and I wasn't able to pay enough attention on the day of delivery because I had other priorities and obligations. My partner, wanting to investigate until the last second in order to find something relevant for the client, generated an automatic report in the software we use. I didn't have time to review it before he sent it to the client, but later that day when I went to look at it, I felt bad about this lack of alignment. The report had a lot of loose images and links associated with them, which at first

glance were meaningless. The information was loose, and clearly didn't generate value for the client.

Talking to my partner, he understood that this was a major point of attention for the project and that this situation must not happen again. In a way, it was less bad that it happened to a friend, but it may still have damaged our reputation a little for supposed recommendations from him.

Conclusion

In terms of developing the project, defining the scope and carrying out the service, the deliveries made during this period were the most important. The construction of the website helped us to clarify the scope of our services and think about the differentiators that will set the company apart from its competitors, and the development of the models made us realize the need for additional pre- and post-investigation processes, such as preparing tools for the start of the case and at the end an internal quality assessment of the service as a whole.

When performing the example case, we skipped many of these steps, which made us realize how important they are. Even though we didn't do a formal quality assessment, we talked about the slip-up with the final report, agreed that our attitude didn't involve the quality practices we wanted and decided that this must never happen again. Albeit informally, we carried out a very valuable quality assessment at the beginning.

In summary, I think this period allowed us to mature the company's internal processes and start to bring our idea to life.